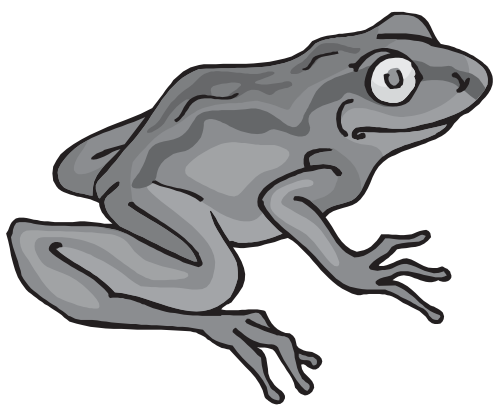
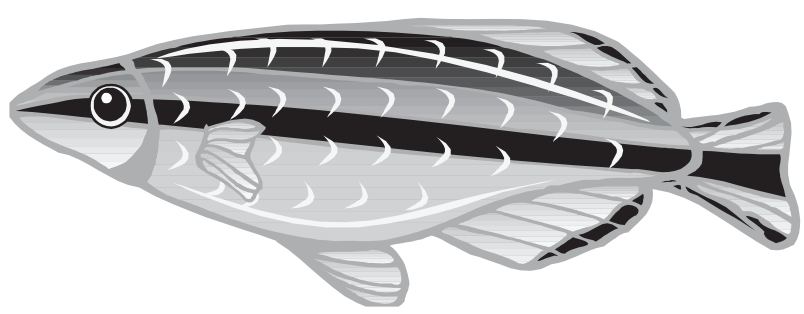
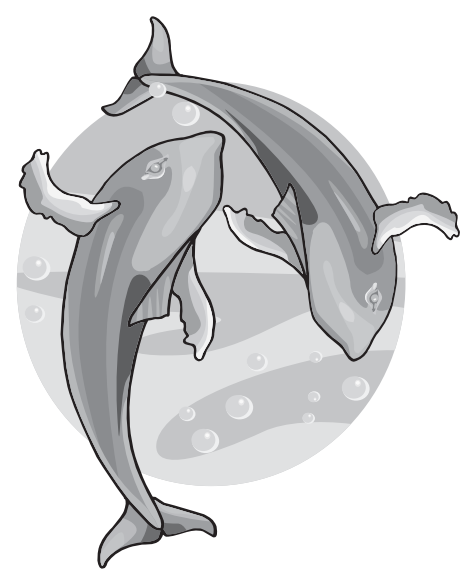
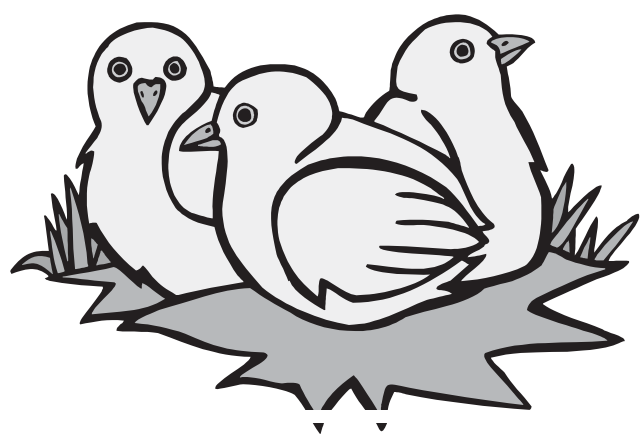
All living organisms can be classified into different groups. The organisms in each of these groups share common characteristics. These are the five main groups that organisms can be placed into: fish, mammals, birds, reptiles, and amphibians. You will learn the traits of these groups that make them special.









Classifying Animals

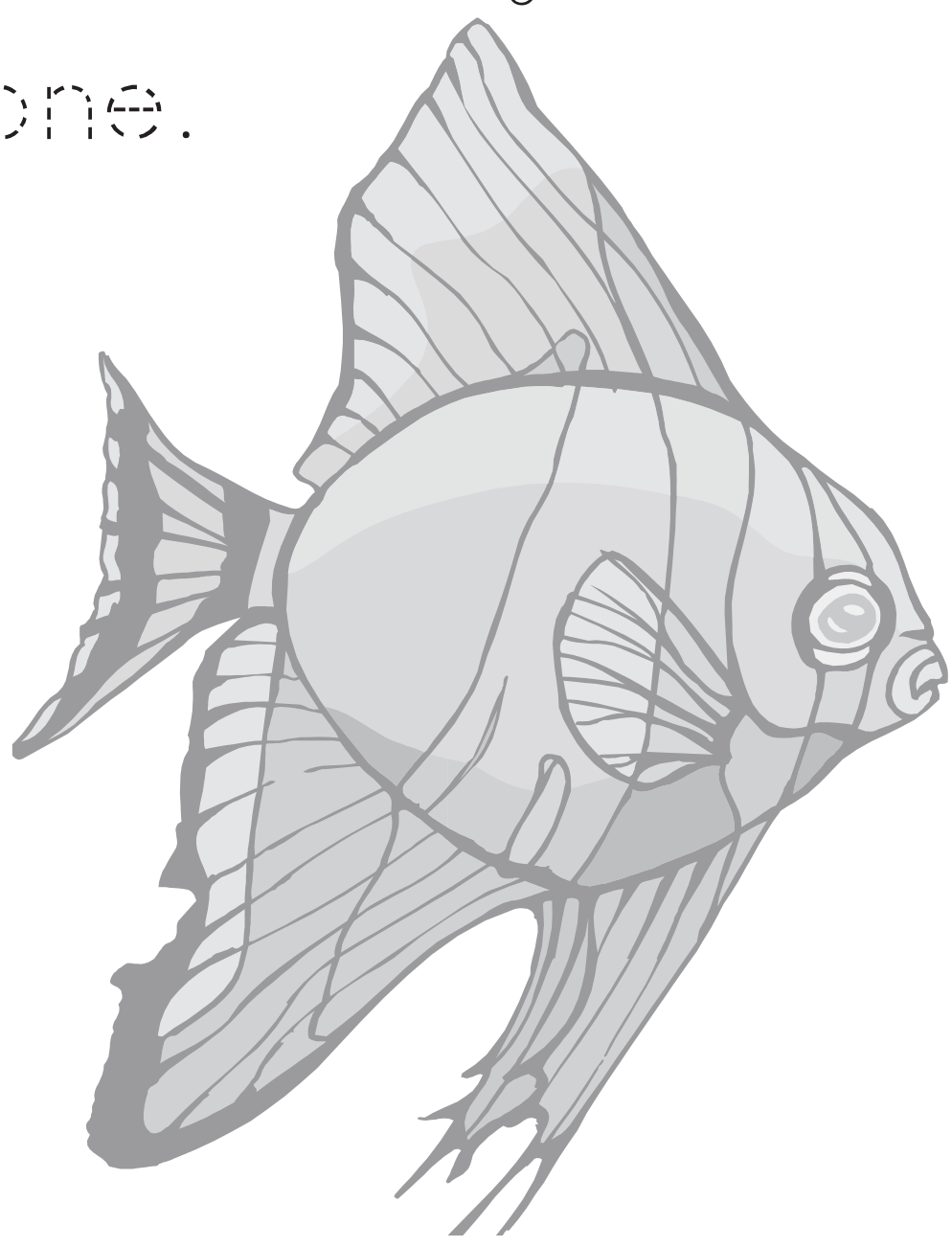
Read and trace the dotted words.

vertebrates	animals with a backbone
invertebrates	animals without a backbone
warm-blooded	body temperature is regulated
cold-blooded	the body temperature changes with the temperature of the environment
trait	distinguishing quality
inherit	to receive characteristics from parents
gills	organs that allow aquatic animals to breathe under water
lungs	organs that allow breathing on land
larvae	young of any invertebrate animal

Word Power

Trace each dotted word and learn each definition.

Fish are cold-blooded animals that spend their whole lives in the water. They have special shaped bodies lined with scales that allow them to move quickly through the water. Another trait specific to the fish is their gills. Gills help the fish take in oxygen from the water to breathe. Fish are also vertebrates, meaning they have a backbone.



Fish

Read and trace each dotted words.

1. _____ are cold-blooded animals that live in the water.

2. Fish take in oxygen to breathe through their _____ _____.

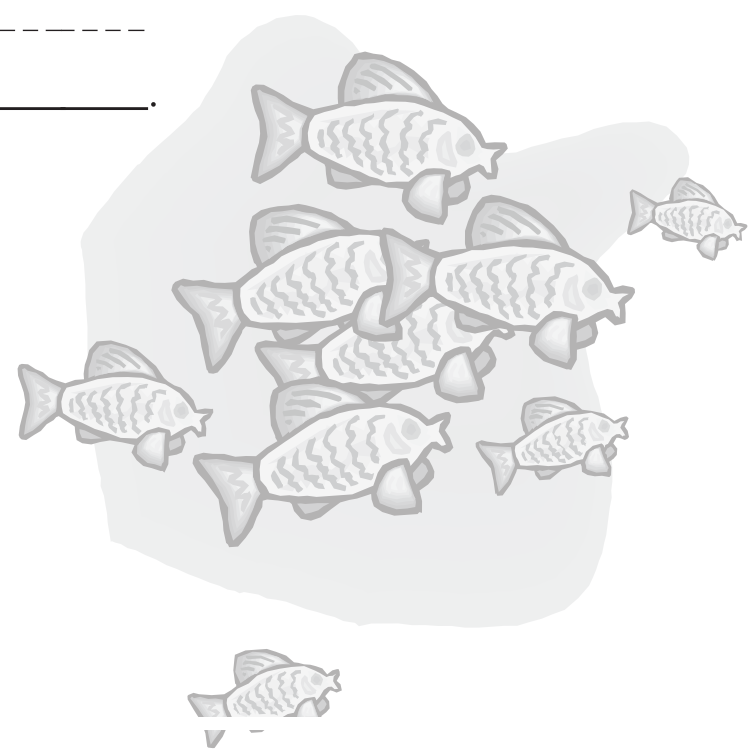
3. The outside of a fish's body is covered with _____ _____ that help them move quickly through the water.

4. Fish have backbones, so they are also _____ _____.

5. Fish live in the _____ _____.

Word Bank

gills	**vertebrates**	**water**
	scales	**fish**



Fish

Fill in the misssing word.

True or False

1. Animals classified into the fish group can live on land.

_____

2. Fish need oxygen to survive.

_____

3. Fish use gills to get oxygen from the water.

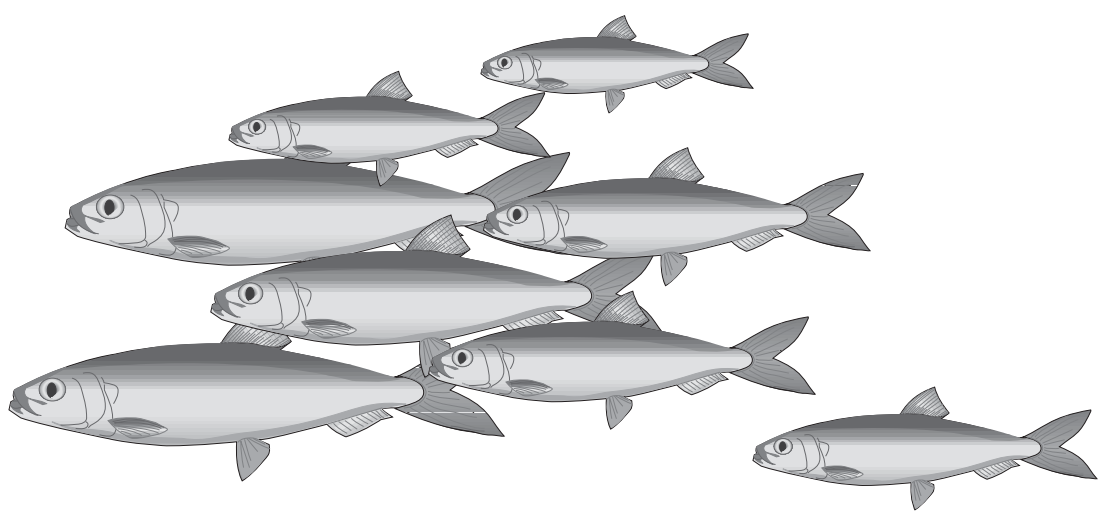
_____

4. Fish have bodies made to move quickly through sand.

_____

5. Fish are warm-blooded, meaning they can regulate their own body temperature.

_____



True or False

1. Animals classified into the fish group can live on land.

_____
False

2. Fish need oxygen to survive.

_____
True

3. Fish use gills to get oxygen from the water.

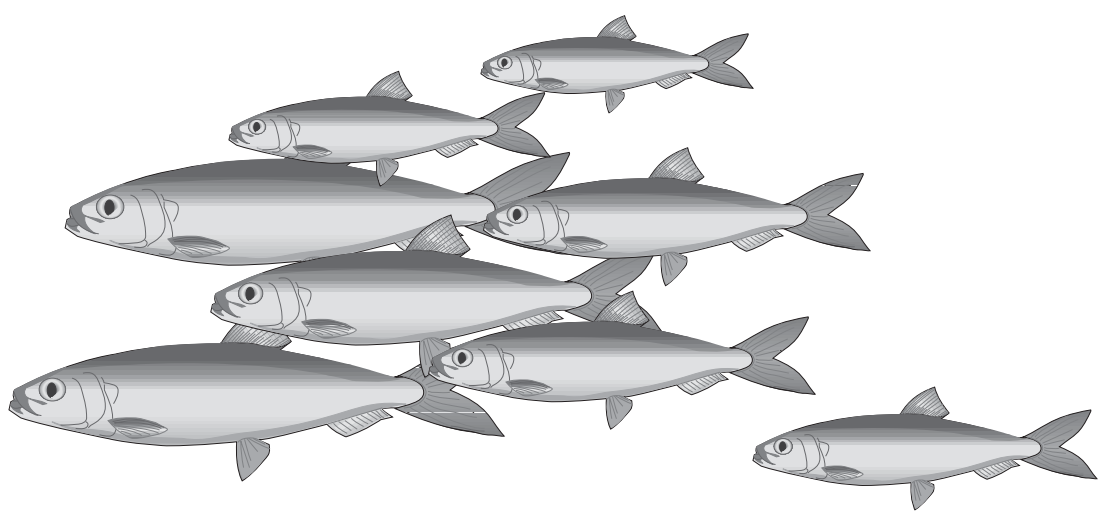
_____
True

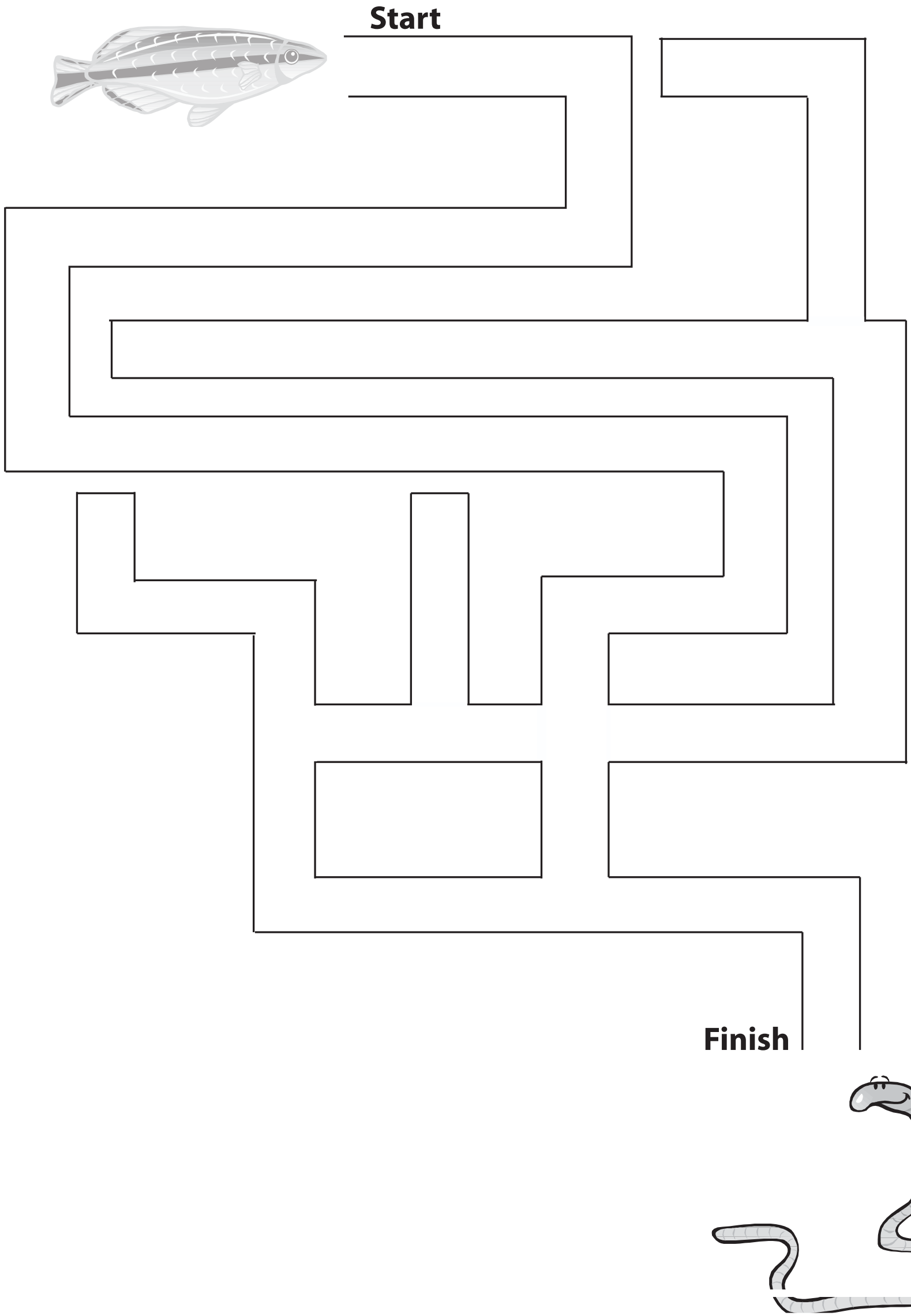
4. Fish have bodies made to move quickly through sand.

_____
False

5. Fish are warm-blooded, meaning they can regulate their own body temperature.

_____
False





Fish

Help the fish catch the worm!

Another group of animals are the mammals. Monkeys, whales, and humans are all part of this group. Mammals are unique because they make milk for their young and have live births. This is significantly different from most animals that hatch from eggs. Mammals have some type of hair on their bodies. It may be thick fur, thin fur, or just a few hairs. Mammals are warm-blooded, which means they can regulate their own body temperature. In cold places, body fat or thick fur helps mammals stay warm, and in very hot conditions they sweat to cool down.

Mammals

Read and trace the dotted words.

1. All mammals have _____ on their bodies.

2. Both people and monkeys are _____.

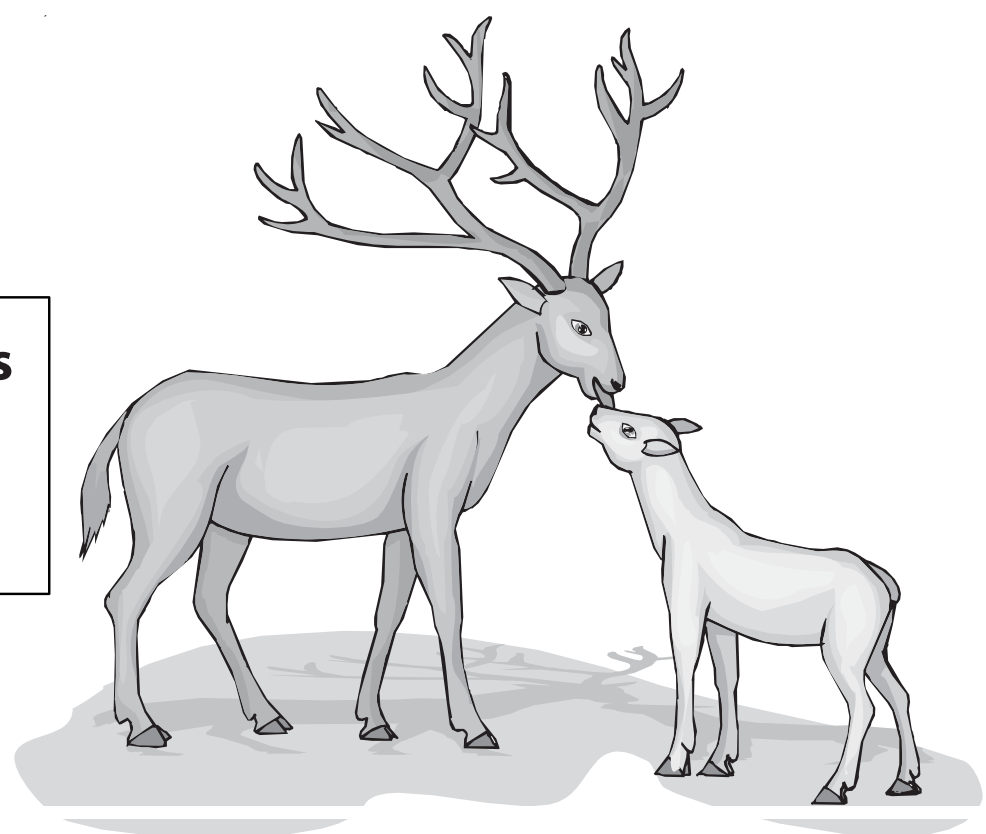
3. The young of mammals are born _____.

4. Warm-blooded animals, like mammals, can _____ regulate their body _____.

5. Female mammals make _____ for their babies.

Word Bank

milk	**temperature**	**mammals**
	alive	**hair**



Mammals

Fill in the blank with the correct answer.

1. All mammals have what on their bodies?

a. freckles b. claws c. hair

2. Female mammals produce this to feed their babies.

a. milk b. hair c. nuts

3. Mammals can regulate their body temperature, so they are:

a. cold-blooded b. warm- blooded c. fat

4. Babies of mammals are born:

a. from eggs b. in nests c. live

5. Humans are:

a. fish b. mammals c. reptiles

Mammals *Underline the correct answer.*

1. All mammals have what on their bodies?

a. freckles b. claws c. hair

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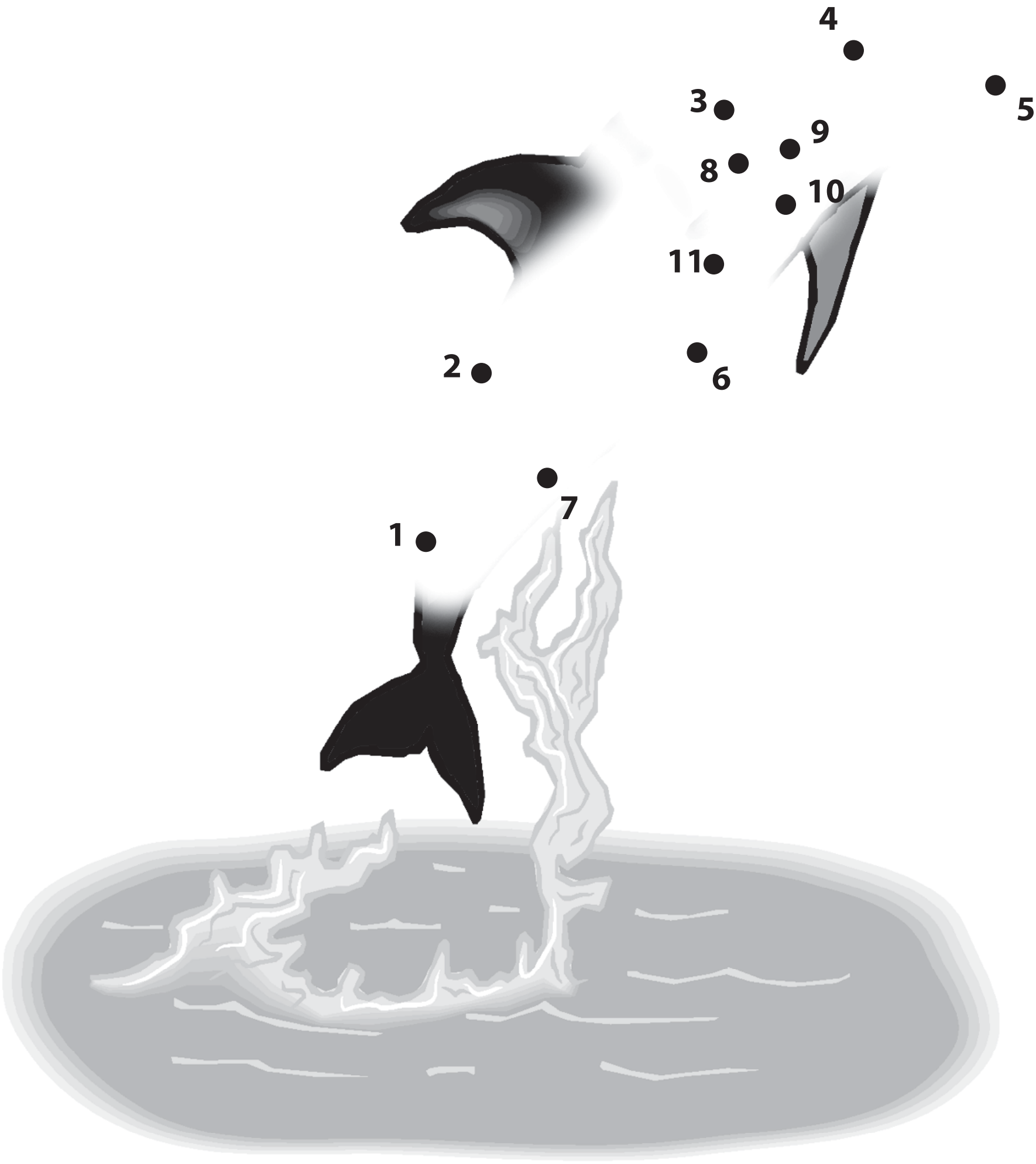


Mammals

Connect the dots to discover an unexpected member of the mammal group!

Animals classified as birds have feathers, two wings, two legs, and a beak. A bird's front two limbs are wings that are usually used for flying. Attached from the chest to the wings are strong muscles that help propel the bird into flight. Since the bird's body is covered in feathers, it is smooth and allows the bird to move easily through the air or water.

Feathers are a trait only found in birds. A bird's babies hatch from eggs. Each egg is covered in a shell. The mother must sit on her eggs till they hatch. After they hatch, the mother will feed and care for her young for a short time. The young birds can usually survive on their own after a short period of time.

Birds are the only animals that

_____

have f_____.

Feathers make the bird's body smooth so it may

_____ _____

glide easily through a_____ or w_____.

_____

Birds lay e_____ and care for their young for a

short period of time.

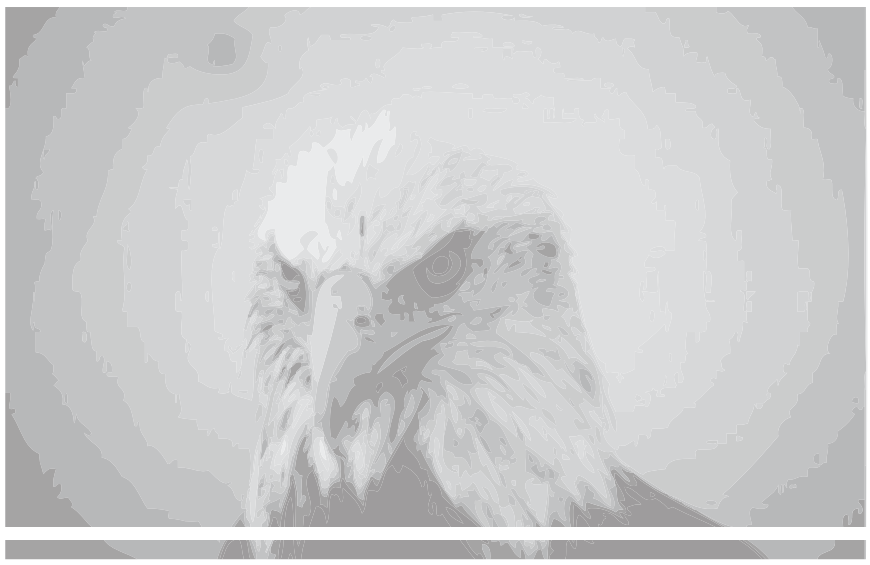
_____

The egg is covered by a s_____ and must be kept

warm by the bird sitting on it.

Word Bank

shell	**eggs**	**water**	**air**	**feathers**



Birds

Fill in the blanks with the correct answer.

1. What covers a bird's body? _____

2. How does a bird have babies? _____

3. Why is a bird covered in feathers? _____

_____

4. How long must the adult bird care for the young?

_____

5. What is the covering of the egg called? _____

6. Name some traits of a bird.

_____

_____

Birds *Fill in the blanks.*

1. What covers a bird's body? _____

feathers

2. How does a bird have babies? _____

lays eggs

3. Why is a bird covered in feathers? _____

_____

helps the bird move easily through air or water

4. How long must the adult bird care for the young?

_____

short period of time

5. What is the covering of the egg called? _____

shell

6. Name some traits of a bird.

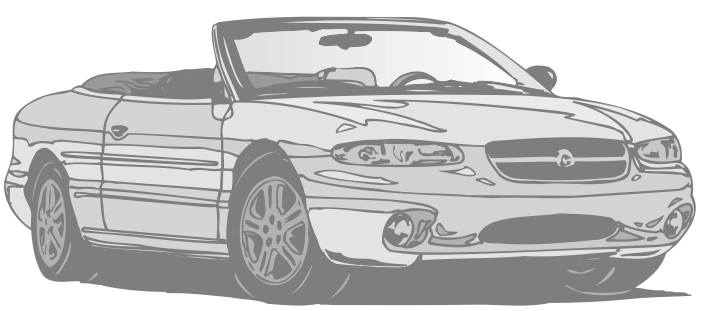
_____

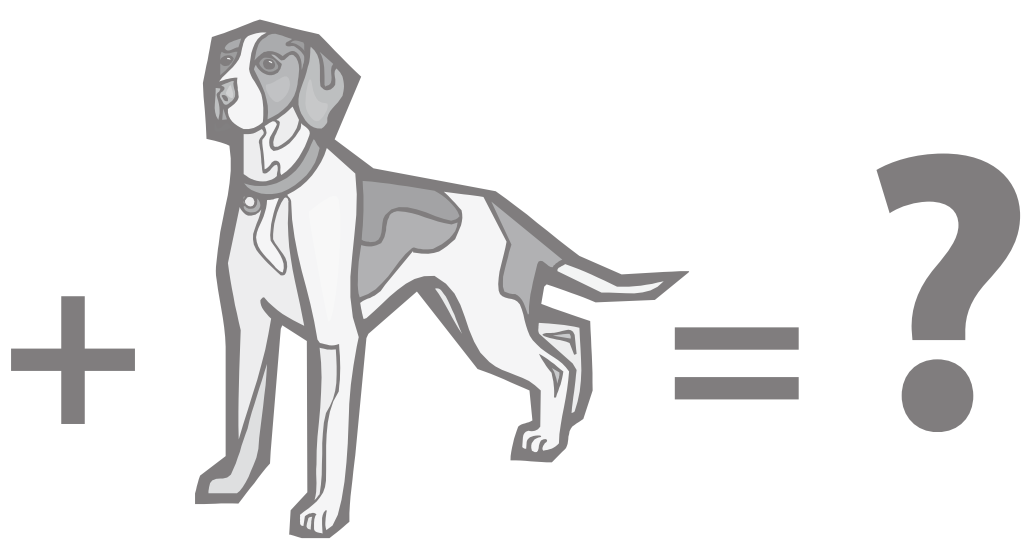
beak, 2 legs, feathers, wings

What do you get when you cross an automobile with a household animal?

19	15	24	25	5	16

1=n	11=f	20=g
2=b	12=u	21=x
3=k	13=w	22=z
4=h	14=m	23=d
5=e	15=a	24=r
6= l	16=t	25=p
7=v	17=l	26=q
8=s	18=j	
9=o	19=c	
10=y		

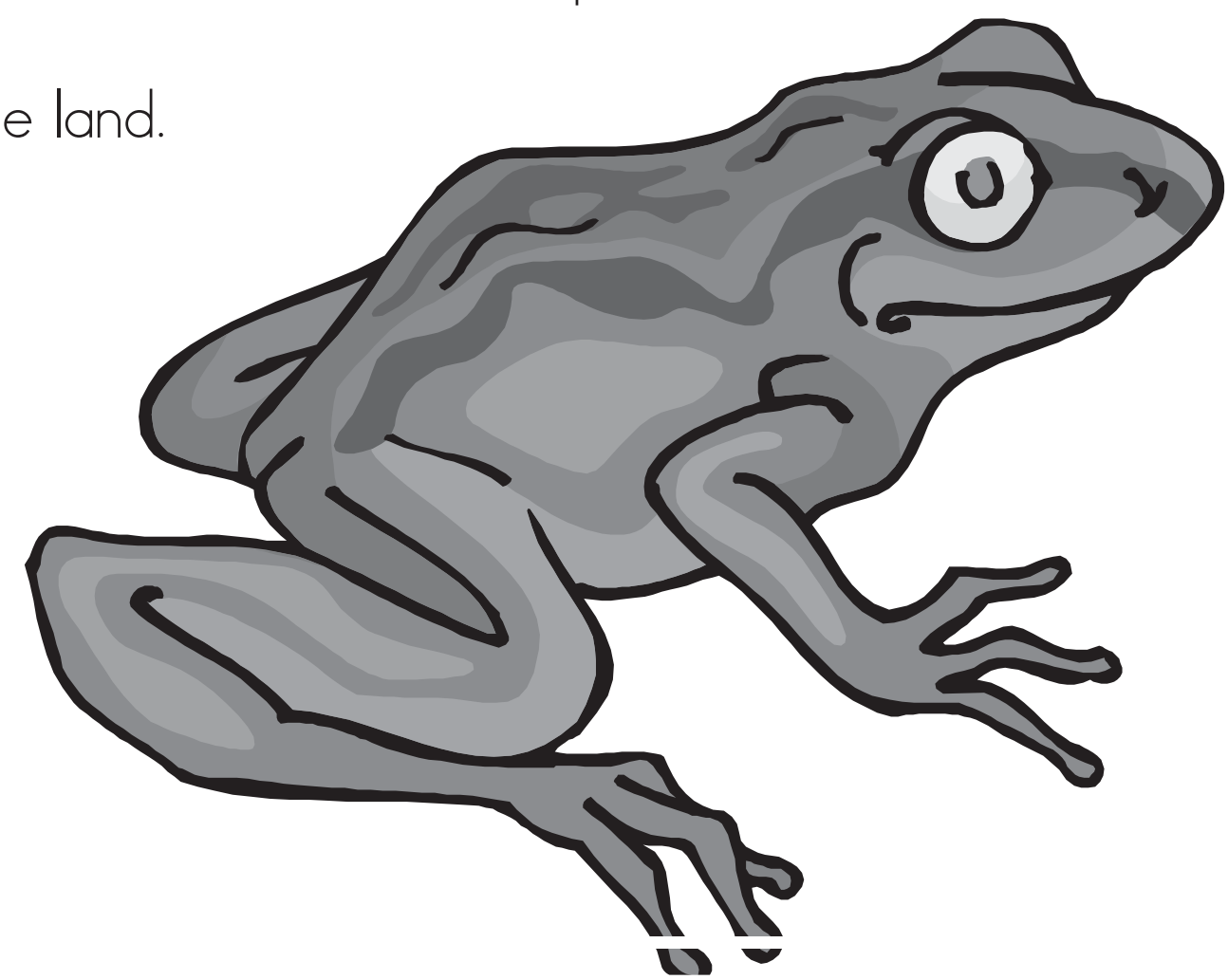




Birds

Solve the riddle. Use the code to see if you are correct.

Amphibians are animals that spend their lives on land and in the water. They're cold-blooded animals that have gills to breathe in the water as larvae and lungs as adults to breathe on land. Some examples of amphibians are frogs & salamanders. Most amphibians lay eggs in the water and are aquatic as larvae. This means they spend their young lives living in the water. As adults, most amphibians are terrestrial, living on the land.



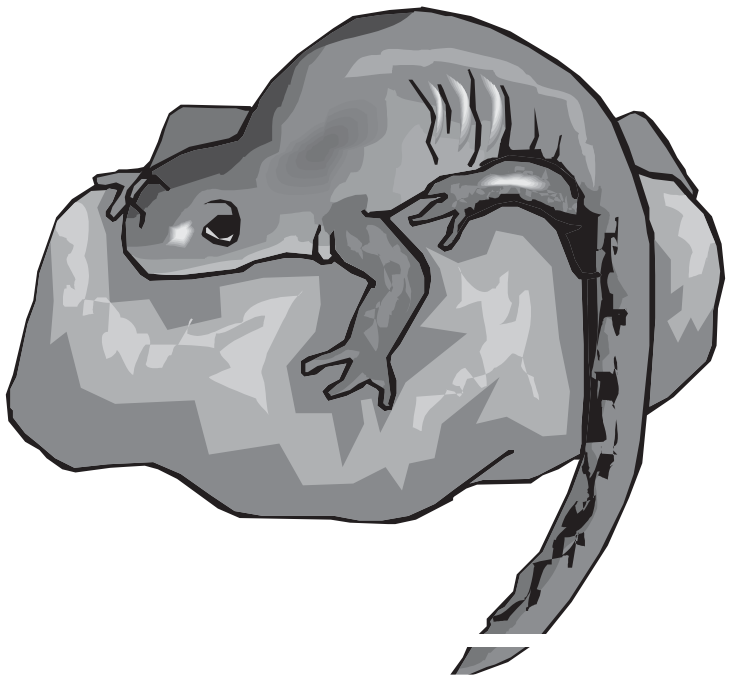
Amphibians

Read and trace the dotted words.

_____ live on both land and water. Frogs and salamanders are both amphibians. Amphibians are able to breathe on land and in water because _____ they have _____ as larvae and, later, _____. As larvae, most amphibians live in the _____. They soon grow; their bodies change, and they move onto _____. Amphibians are _____.

Word Bank

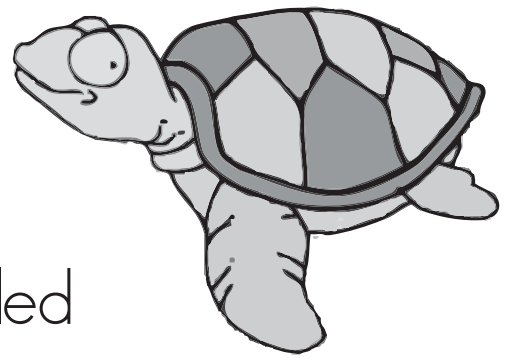
land	**water**	**lungs**
gills	**amphibians**	**blooded**



Amphibians

Fill in the blank with the correct word.

1. What allows amphibians to breathe on land?



_____

2. Animals that live on land and in water are called

_____.

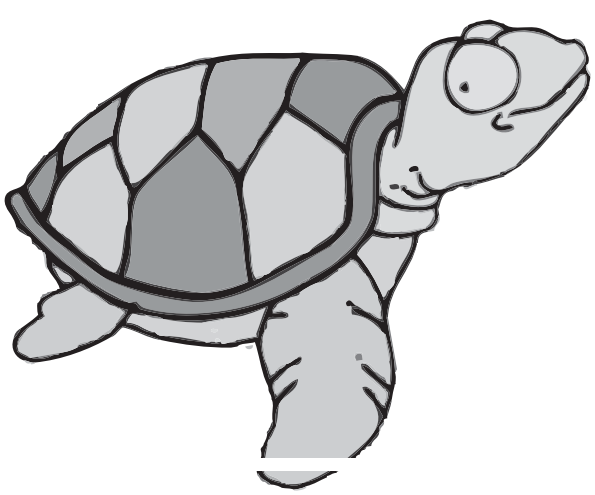
3._____ take in oxygen from the water, allowing animals to breathe.

4. If the body temperature depends on the environment an animal is: _____

5. One example of an amphibian is a _____.

6. A young amphibian can also be called a

_____.



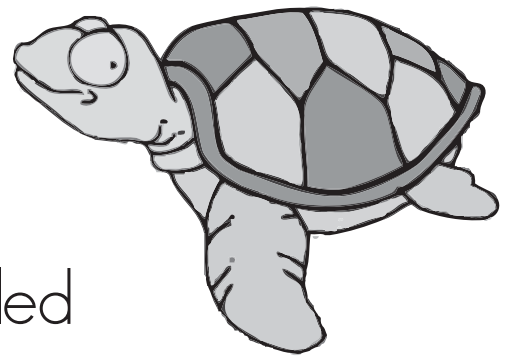
Word Bank

larvae	**cold- blooded**	**frog**
gills	**lungs**	**amphibians**

Amphibians

Fill in the correct word from the Word Bank.

1. What allows amphibians to breathe on land?



_____
lungs

2. Animals that live on land and in water are called

_____.
amphibians

3._____ take in oxygen from the water, allowing
gills
animals to breathe.

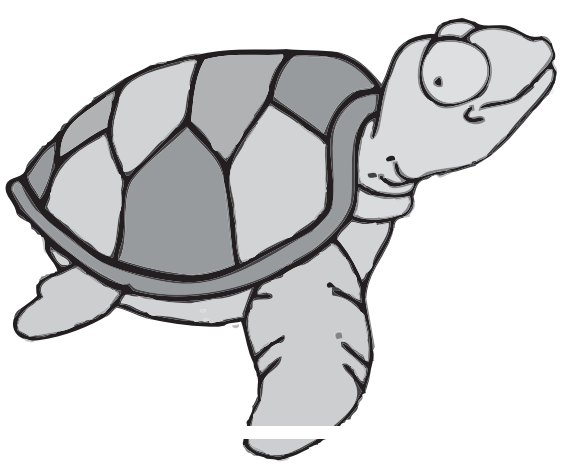
4. If the body temperature depends on the environment an

animal is: _____
cold-blooded

5. One example of an amphibian is a _____.
frog

6. A young amphibian can also be called a

_____.
larvae

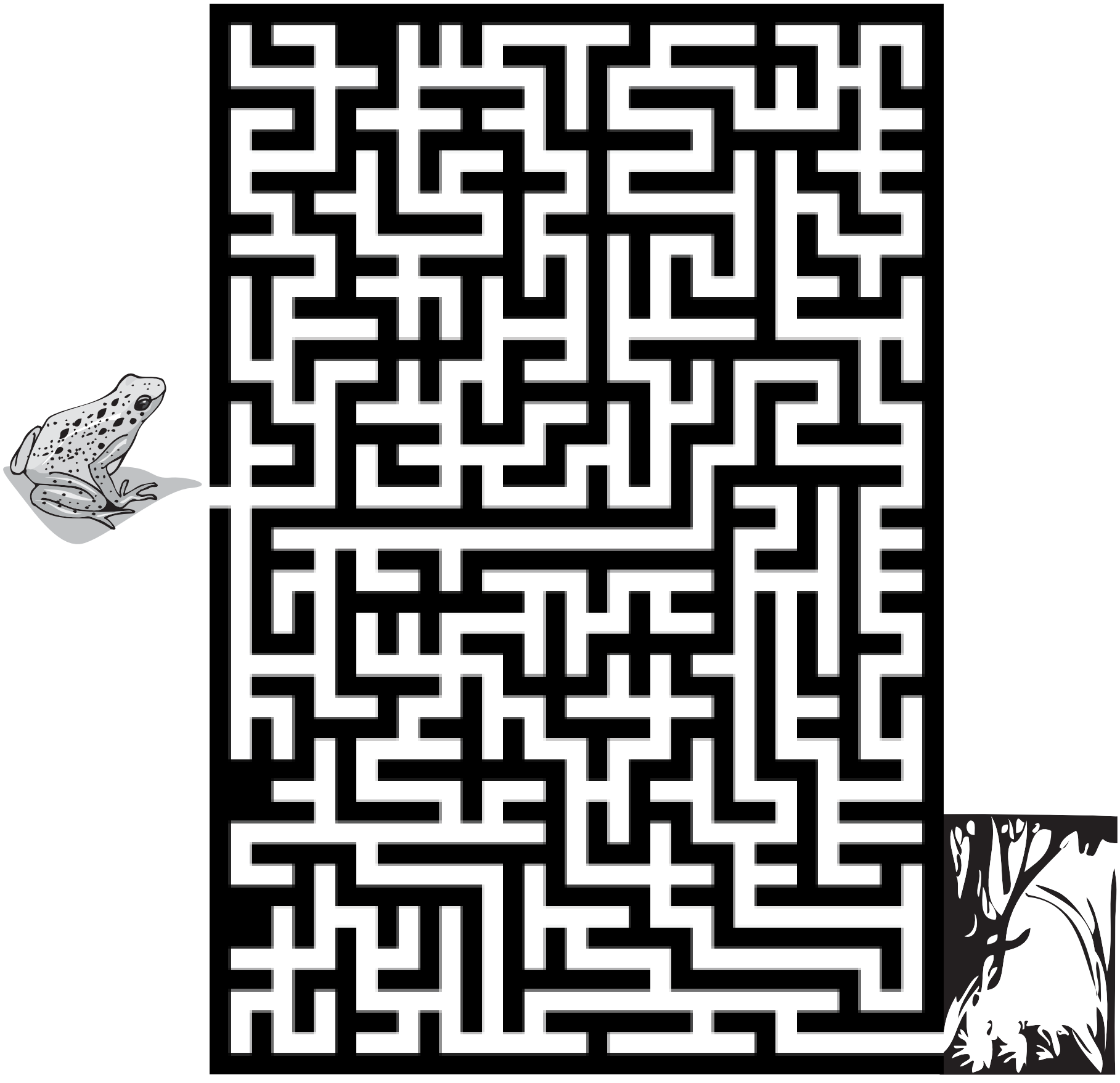


Word Bank

larvae	**cold- blooded**	**frog**
gills	**lungs**	**amphibians**

Amphibians *Answers*

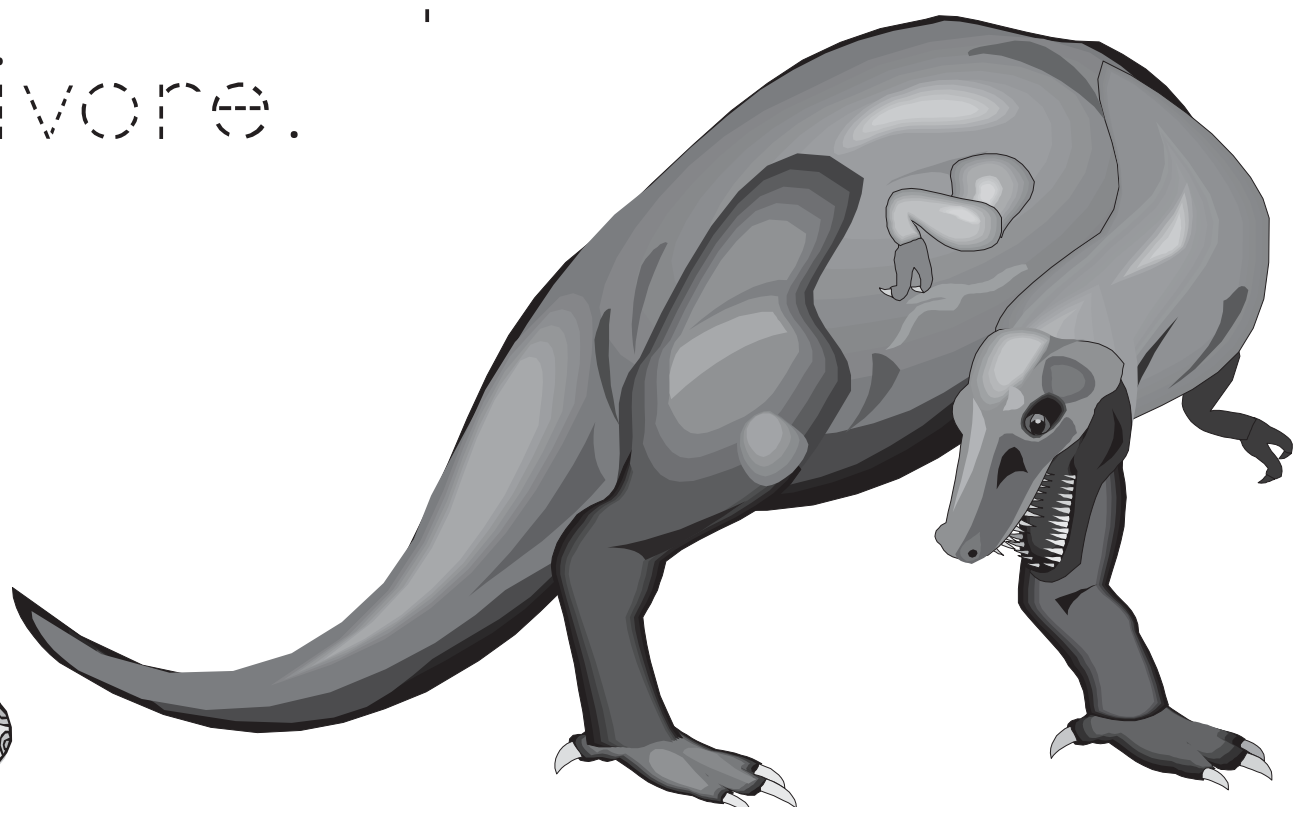
The Poison Arrow Frog is one amphibian you don't want to mess with! These brightly colored frogs can kill a grown man with just a brush of their toxic skin. Help this frog find its way home.



Amphibians

Solve the maze.

A reptile is an animal that has scaly, waterproof skin. Their tough skin helps keep water in their bodies. They live on land and are cold-blooded. Snakes, alligators, and even the extinct dinosaurs are all part of this group. Reptiles use their lungs to breathe and most of them lay eggs. Some reptiles, like the King Cobra, are carnivores. A carnivore's diet consists of meat. Other reptiles, like turtles, eat plants. This kind of animal is called a herbivore.



Reptiles

Read and trace the dotted words.

Reptiles have scaly, _____

w_____ skin.

_____

They live on land and lay e_____. They

cannot regulate their own body

temperature because they are

_____ _____

c_____-_____. Reptiles

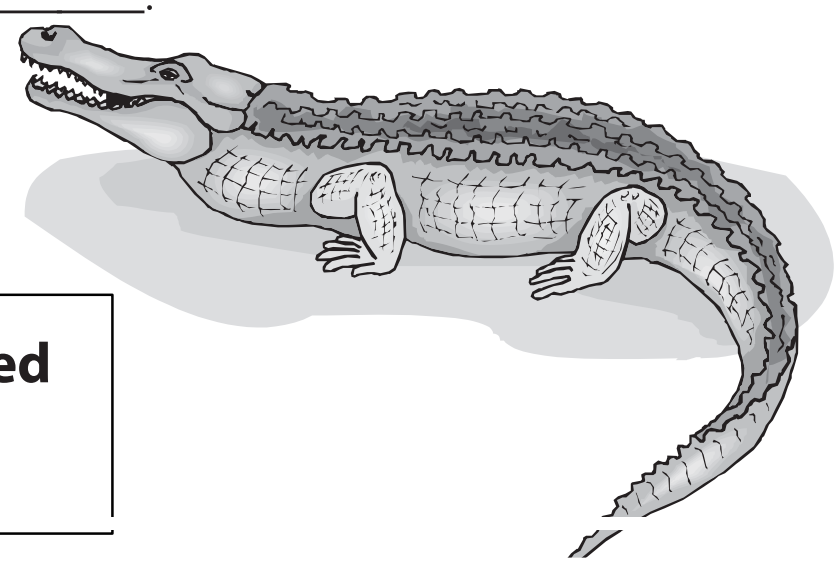
_____

use their lungs to b_____. Some

reptiles are carnivores, and some are

_____

h_____.



Word Bank

herbivores	**breathe**	**cold-blooded**
eggs	**waterproof**	

Reptiles

Fill in the blanks.

1. cold- blooded animal with scaly skin •

2. meat-eating reptile •

3. allows reptiles to breathe •

4. plant-eating reptile •

5. reptile that is extinct •

6. way in which reptiles are born •

• dinosaur

• eggs

• King Cobra

• reptile

• turtle

• lungs

Reptiles

Match the description to the correct answers.

1. cold- blooded animal with scaly skin
2. meat-eating reptile
3. allows reptiles to breathe
4. plant-eating reptile
5. reptile that is extinct
6. way in which reptiles are born

- dinosaur
- eggs
- King Cobra
- reptile
- turtle
- lungs

zalidr _____

pthnoy _____

bamma _____

kcoge _____

namcai _____

trulet _____

abo _____

ocrab

Word Bank

boa	**mamba**	**cobra**	**gecko**
python	**lizard**	**turtle**	**caiman**

Reptiles

Unscramble the words to discover other types of reptiles.

Each group of animals has unique traits inherited from their parents. Animals in the fish group live in the water, breathe with gills, lay eggs, and are cold-blooded. They have a backbone, meaning they are vertebrates. Mammals are warm-blooded, have live babies, lungs for breathing and have hair or fur. Humans are a type of mammal and are also vertebrates. Birds are the only animal with feathers. These animals also lay eggs and are cold-blooded. Birds also have a backbone. Amphibians are the only animals with both lungs and gills so they can live on land and water. They lay their eggs in water, live their young life there, and eventually move to land. These creatures are cold-blooded and vertebrates. Reptiles are also cold-blooded. They live on land and breathe with lungs. Most reptiles lay eggs. Reptiles, like

Review *Read and trace the dotted words.*

1. _____ live in the water and breathe with _____.

2. Mammals are _____ and have live babies.

3. Reptiles lay _____ and have scaly _____.

4. _____ have feathers and are warm-blooded.

5. Amphibians live on the _____ and in the _____.

6. Amphibians are _____ and lay eggs, so do reptiles and fish.

7. Only mammals are warm-_____ and have live young.

Word Bank

cold-blooded	**gills**	**fish**	**blooded**	**birds**
land	**water**	**eggs**	**skin**	**warm- blooded**

Review

Fill in the blanks above.

1. What do amphibians, reptiles, fish, and birds all have in common? _____

2. What group are you a part of? _____

3. How can an amphibian live on land and in water?

_____

4. What feature do all birds share? _____

5. List the five animal groups. _____

_____

_____

6. Could a snake live in extreme cold? Why or why not?

_____

Review

Write the answer to each question.

1. What do amphibians, reptiles, fish, and birds all have in common? _____

they lay eggs

2. What group are you a part of? _____

mammals

3. How can an amphibian live on land and in water?

_____

they have gills and lungs

4. What feature do all birds share? _____

feathers

5. List the five animal groups. _____

_____

_____

birds, mammals, fish, reptiles, amphibians

6. Could a snake live in extreme cold? Why or why not?

_____

No, because they are cold-blooded

Using traits from each animal group, create your own animal. Draw it in its natural habitat. What will it eat. How will it move?

Review

Draw your own animal!

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